The middle and the spread

Data science · Level 1 · Lesson 2



In this lesson you will

- Work out the mean, median and mode.
- See how one extreme value pulls the mean.
- Measure the spread with the range.

Key ideas

- Mean: share it out equally.
- Median: the middle one; it resists extremes.
- Always give a spread with the middle.

Find the middle

1. Warm-up (5 min): Line up!
2. Collect (10 min): Ten numbers.
3. Work out (10 min): Mean, median, range.
4. Wrap-up (5 min): What did you find out?

Let’s discuss

1. Why did one big number move the mean?
2. Which middle did you choose?
3. What does the range add?

Exit ticket

- For 2, 4, 4 and 10, write the mean, the median, the mode and the range.